

GLASSHOUSE

DRIVING THE POINT HOME

Maharashtra tourism minister **Aaditya Thackeray** recently drove deputy CM and state finance minister Ajit Pawar around his South Mumbai constituency, Worli. Thackeray Jr showed Pawar how the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) had redone roads and beautified Worli. At a virtual meeting that same evening, senior Sena leaders complained to Chief Minister Uddhav Thackeray that Pawar was partisan in allocating funds. NCP-run ministries were allocated 49 per cent of the state budget but Sena ministries got only 19 per cent. Was the photo-op then Thackeray's way of telling Pawar that Sena doesn't need his money, it already controls the cash-rich BMC?

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

ANI



A Special Desire

Andhra Pradesh CM **Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy** has consistently spurned offers to join the NDA. His precondition: accord AP special category status (SCS) so that the cash-strapped state can get additional funds. Hopes ran high when the Union home ministry included SCS among inter-state issues to discuss at a meeting with Telangana representatives. Alas, it was dropped at the last minute. The prime minister too recently said that the bifurcation hurt both states. Hope is dead, long live hope.

Building History

Senior Congress leader **Anant Gadgil** has long offered to turn his family home in Pune into an 'inspiration centre'. His party, though, has been cold to the idea. The 90-year-old, two-storeyed mansion was a hub of political activity during the freedom movement. It was also where the Rashtra Seva Dal was conceived. Gadgil, an architect, is running out of patience; he has now started documenting the building's history on his own.



COVERING UP

Cabinet ministers in Madhya Pradesh have a habit of shooting their mouths off, leaving CM Shivraj Singh Chouhan to make amends. Recently, when school education minister **Inder Singh Parmar** hinted that he favoured banning hijabs in government schools, home minister Narottam Mishra had to clear the air next day, saying no such issue was under consideration. Parmar, a Sangh favourite, said later that his words were taken out of context. A warning shot from the CM, perhaps?



–Sandeep Unnithan with Kiran D. Tare, Amarnath K. Menon and Rahul Noronha